Progress Test 1 — after Lessons 1 to 3

Level: A2 · checks Lessons 1, 2 and 3

Theme: Everything so far: daily routine, keeping files safe, and computing

Time: about 90 minutes, in one sitting if possible

Skills: Listening → Reading → Vocabulary and grammar → Writing → Speaking

New in this lesson: two texts she has never seen, the eight TOEFL question types from Lessons 1 to 3, and a score that says which lesson to go back to

01 · Section 1 — Listening

Section 1 — Listening (20 marks, about 20 minutes)

> Do not read anything in this section before you listen. Play `01-listening.mp3`. You will hear a short passage two times, then the six questions. Answer on this sheet.

1. (Factual, 3 marks) What time does Nadia arrive at the office?

   A. At seven o'clock.
   B. At eight o'clock.
   C. At nine o'clock.
   D. The passage does not say.

2. (Factual, 3 marks) What was Nadia doing when her colleague turned the computer off?

   A. She was checking the printer.
   B. She was writing a long report.
   C. She was reading her email.
   D. She was talking to the room.

3. (Negative factual, 3 marks) According to the passage, the office did all of the following EXCEPT

   A. make a new rule.
   B. ask people to look at the screen first.
   C. buy a second computer.
   D. ask people to ask the room first.

4. (Vocabulary in context, 3 marks) The word "shared" in the last line is closest in meaning to

   A. used by many people.
   B. very old.
   C. broken.
   D. bought last week.

5. (Inference, 3 marks) It can be inferred from the passage that

   A. Nadia lost a whole day of work.

   B. the colleague turned the computer off on purpose.

   C. Nadia now keeps more than one copy of her work.

   D. the office bought a new printer.

6. (Short answer, 5 marks) What rule did the office make after Nadia lost her work?

> _____

02 · Section 2 — Reading

Section 2 — Reading (30 marks, about 25 minutes)

Passage: Two Kinds of Memory (241 words)

A computer keeps information in two different places, and the difference between them matters every single day.

The first place is the memory the computer uses while it is working. Programmers call it RAM. When you open a file, the computer copies it into this memory, because this memory is very fast. But it is not safe. [A] When the electricity stops, everything inside it disappears immediately.

The second place is the disk. [B] The disk is slower, but it keeps your files when the machine is off. This is why your teacher tells you to save often. Saving means moving your work from the fast memory to the slow one.

Many students learn this rule the hard way. [C] They write for two hours, the power stops, and the work is gone — not because the computer is broken, but because the work never left the fast memory.

There is a second lesson after the first one. A file on one disk is still a file in one place. [D] If the disk stops working, or the laptop is lost, the file is gone with it. A backup is a copy on a different machine, in a different place.

Good habits are small ones. Save every few minutes. Keep one copy somewhere else. Then, once a month, check that the second copy really opens. Many people make backups for years without ever testing them, and they discover the problem on the worst possible day.

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1. (Factual, 4 marks) What does the computer do when you open a file?

   A. It copies the file into the fast memory.
   B. It sends the file to another machine.
   C. It makes a backup of the file.
   D. It turns the disk off.

2. (Factual, 4 marks) According to the passage, what is the disk good at?

   A. Working very fast.
   B. Keeping files when the machine is off.
   C. Making copies on other machines.
   D. Testing backups once a month.

3. (Negative factual, 4 marks) The writer advises all of the following EXCEPT

   A. save every few minutes.
   B. keep one copy somewhere else.
   C. check that the second copy opens.

D. buy a faster computer.

4. (Vocabulary in context, 4 marks) The word "disappears" in paragraph 2 is closest in meaning to

A. becomes slow.

B. is gone.

C. is copied.

D. is saved.

5. (Reference, 4 marks) In the sentence, if the disk stops working, the file is gone with it, the word "it" refers to

A. the backup.

B. the fast memory.

C. the disk.

D. the copy.

6. (Inference, 4 marks) It can be inferred from the passage that

A. a backup on the same disk is not really a backup.

B. RAM is more useful than a disk.

C. most students never lose their work.

D. testing a backup is a waste of time.

7. (Sentence insertion, 3 marks) Look at the four letters [A] [B] [C] [D] in the passage. Where would this sentence best fit?

> It exists only while the power is on.

- A. At [A]
- B. At [B]
- C. At [C]
- D. At [D]

8. (Purpose of a paragraph, 3 marks) Why does the writer mention students who write for two hours?

A. To show what happens when work never leaves the fast memory.

B. To explain how a disk is built.

C. To show that students work too slowly.

D. To criticise teachers who ask for long essays.

03 · Section 3 — Vocabulary and grammar

Section 3 — Vocabulary and grammar (30 marks, about 20 minutes)

Part A — Vocabulary (10 marks, 1 each). Write one word in each gap.

1. A home inside a building is a ____.
2. A second copy of your files in another place is a ____.
3. A big computer that keeps files for many people is a ____.
4. The program you use to open websites is a ____.
5. To put electricity into a battery is to ____.
6. To go away and not be seen is to ____.
7. Not able to move = ____.
8. In every place = ____.
9. A thing you use to do work is a ____.
10. The opposite of upload is ____.

Part B — Grammar (10 marks, 1 each). Put the verb in the right tense, or choose the right word.

1. Every morning Sami ____ (wake up) at six o'clock.
2. Last year Maha ____ (study) design.
3. She ____ (not find) her phone.
4. ____ you ____ (have) a backup?
5. At eight o'clock Omar ____ (sit) at his desk.
6. The students ____ (laugh) when the lights went out.
7. The computer turned off while it ____ (write) to the server.
8. Omar ____ (not laugh).
9. He was uploading his files ____ the screen stopped. (when / while)
10. ____ she was typing, the power stopped. (when / while)

Part C — The three sounds of -ed (5 marks, 1 each). Write /t/, /d/ or /ɪd/.

1. looked ____
2. explained ____
3. wanted ____
4. helped ____
5. needed ____

Part D — Which word is different? (5 marks, 1 each.) Circle it.

1. server — browser — software — breakfast
2. studied — took — kept — important

3. cable — screen — drive — version
4. slow — stuck — quick — fast
5. backup — copy — folder — careful

04 · Section 4 — Writing

Section 4 — Writing (10 marks, about 15 minutes)

Write 10–12 sentences about this:

> A day when technology let you down. What were you doing? What happened? What do you do differently now?

You must use:

- the past continuous at least twice (I was working…, while I was typing…);
- the past simple for the short action that interrupted it;
- at least five words from Lessons 1, 2 and 3.

How it is marked

	MARKS
The story is clear and in the right order	3
Past simple and past continuous used correctly	4
Five or more course words used correctly	2
Capital letters and full stops	1

05 · Section 5 — Speaking

Section 5 — Speaking (10 marks, about 10 minutes)

Play `05-speaking.mp3`. You have 15 seconds to prepare and 45 seconds to speak for each question. Record all three answers on your phone and send them to your teacher.

1. Describe your morning. Use wake up, breakfast, then, and after that.
2. Tell me about a time you lost something, or a time your work stopped. What were you doing? What happened?
3. Where do you keep your most important files, and why is that safe?

How it is marked

	MARKS
The answer is on the question and long enough	3
Tenses are mostly correct	3
Course vocabulary is used	2
Speech is clear, without long stops	2